Behaviour scripts

Correcting calmly and precisely

Use calm, precise behaviour language to restore learning while preserving relationships. Apply the school behaviour system consistently and keep the response focused on the action that needs to change.

How to do it well

1 Describe and direct. State the observable behaviour and the expected action instead of asking a confrontational 'why' question.

2 Use partial agreement. Acknowledge the pupil's comment without abandoning the expectation: 'Maybe so—and the instruction still stands.'

3 Allow take-up time. Give the direction once, move attention back to teaching and return later to check compliance rather than creating a public stand-off.

4 Focus on primary behaviour. Address what is interrupting learning and, unless serious, avoid escalating a sigh, mutter or eye-roll that follows the correction.

5 Offer directed choices. Give two acceptable, behaviour-based options, state the consequence calmly and follow through consistently.

What this sounds like

"You are talking while I am explaining. Stop the conversation and listen to this step. Thank you."

Classroom example. During silent practice, one pupil starts a conversation. The teacher gives a brief description and direction, allows take-up time and resumes monitoring. A quiet return checks that the pupil has begun the task. When another pupil starts promptly, the teacher recognises the specific action. The correction does not become a public debate.

Top tips that make the technique work

Describe and direct. Name the observable behaviour and the required action, avoiding questions that invite an argument.

Allow take-up time. Give a clear direction, move attention away where appropriate, and return to check compliance.

Use partial agreement carefully. Acknowledge a point without abandoning the expectation: "Even if you were helping, this is silent work."

Focus on the primary behaviour. Avoid escalating a minor sigh or facial expression while correcting the disruption, unless the secondary behaviour is serious.

Make praise precise. Positive narration and recognition should identify the useful learning action rather than publicly rank pupils.

Do and avoid

Do	Avoid
Use brief, predictable language and follow through.	Debating publicly or reacting emotionally.
Begin with the least intrusive effective response.	Inventing consequences outside the agreed school system.

Further reading

Practitioner guidance; teacher language above is an illustrative BSCS adaptation.

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